

PAID IN FULL

* ITEMS IN BLUE DENOTE POWER POINT
SLIDES

* ITEMS IN BROWN DENOTE INSTRUCTIONS
TO THE TECHNICIAN

TEXT: 1 Peter 1:18-19 (NKJV) “...*You were not redeemed with corruptible things, like silver or gold, from your aimless conduct received by tradition from your fathers, ¹⁹but with the precious blood of Christ, as of a lamb without blemish and without spot.*” 1 Peter 1:18-19 (CEV) “*You were rescued from the useless way of life that you learned from your ancestors. But you know that you were not rescued by such things as silver or gold that don’t last forever. ¹⁹You were rescued by the precious blood of Christ, that spotless and innocent lamb.*”

INTRO: Some people are very organized and others are, well, less organized. Those who are organized get more done with less effort. Over the long haul organization allows our lives to count for a whole lot more. We serve a God of order; He is never without a plan. The fall of man did not catch Him by surprise, He knew it was coming and He immediately rolled out a plan of redemption. Think of this, before we ever sinned, God developed a plan to forgive the sin!

The bottom line is this, sin carries a high cost but before the cost was ever incurred the price was paid to satisfy the fee of sin.

When we know something is already paid for, it takes the pressure off. (The feeling of writing the last check on a long standing debt is exhilarating) A tremendous price was paid for the sins of each person in this place today.

When the enemy or an individual tries to remind us of our past, what they are really saying is that we owe a debt which has not been satisfied. (SONG: *"He paid a debt He did not owe; I owed a debt I could not pay. Christ Jesus paid a debt I could never pay"*)

The fact is, each of us has incurred a debt of sin which we could never hope to satisfy but Jesus stepped up to the plate and paid the debt for us. The debt has been paid in full!

I. THE SINNER AND THE LAW

John 8:1-5 (NKJV) ***"But Jesus went to the Mount of Olives. 2 Now early in the morning He came again into the temple, and all the people came to Him; and He sat down and taught them. 3 Then the scribes and Pharisees brought to Him a woman caught in adultery. And when they had set her in the midst, 4 they said to Him, "Teacher, this woman was caught in adultery, in the very act. 5 "Now Moses, in the law, commanded us that such should be stoned. But what do You say?"*** This woman was caught in the very act of adultery and the religious establishment wanted to make sure she paid the full price which the law demanded. In this scenario the woman:

- Sinned – Committed adultery.
- Was Caught – Condemned by the law.

- Was publicly humiliated – Either we will embarrass sin or sin will embarrass us.
- Brought to justice – Condemned by the religious establishment.

I have a very important question regarding this event; where is the man? The last time I checked it takes two to tango!

Be assured, the devil and the world cry out for justice, God's modus operandi is grace. The law demands a prescribed punishment for sin. The feeling of many religious people is that if one has sinned, justice should be administered swiftly and sternly. The feeling seems to be "If a person has sinned they should pay the price without mercy."

Remember we are talking about sin, not a crime! Not every crime is a sin, and not every sin is a crime! For instance, in a country where it is illegal to read the Bible, reading the Bible may be a crime but it is certainly not a sin. In the U.S., Adultery is not a crime but rest assured it is a sin!

There is just something in the make-up of mankind that cries out for personal mercy while demanding justice for others! Before we make too many demands concerning the sins of others we should stop to recount how many sins we have committed which have never come to light. (Texas A&M – 1936 hide & go seek champion of the world)

The law says the price must be paid without mercy!
In this case, the woman caught in adultery deserved to die for her sin! Under the law there was no wiggle room in the penalty phase, she was a doomed woman!

Though she was a condemned woman, grace (Jesus) was about to show up and set her free! She had created a debt which seemed to only be able to be satisfied by the loss of her life. The debt was about to be paid in full!

What Jesus did for the woman caught in the act of adultery He will do for everyone. His reason for being is to meet us at the point of our most critical need.

Who is this Jesus?

- He is the First and Last
- He is the Beginning and the End.
- He is the keeper of Creation and the Creator of all
- He is the Architect of the universe and its Manager
- He always was, He always is, and He always will be
- He is unmoved, unchanged, undefeated, and never to be out-done
- He was bruised yet He brought healing
- He was pierced yet He has eased the pain of the world
- He was persecuted and brought freedom to tens of millions
- He was dead but He brought life to the dying

- He is risen and brings power to the powerless
- He reigns and brings peace to a world which knows no peace

The world can't understand him, the armies can't defeat Him, the schools can't explain Him, and the leaders can't ignore Him. Herod couldn't kill Him, the Pharisees couldn't confuse Him, and the grave couldn't hold Him! Nero couldn't crush Him, Hitler couldn't silence Him, New Age can't replace Him, and sinners cannot get Him off their hands!

The law say's the sinner must die for his/her sins, but Jesus paid in full the penalty for all offenses!

II. THE SINNER AND GRACE

Romans 5:20 (NKJV) “... *But where sin abounded, grace abounded much more,*”

In the case of the woman caught in the act of adultery, sin abounded in her life! This was probably not her first affair!

Almost everyone I know who has been caught in such a sin claims this was their first offense. If this is the case they are either the most inauspicious person on the earth or they are as dumb as a box of rocks!

A person who gets caught in such a failure usually has developed a lifestyle which has become very careless. God ALWAYS sends mercy before he sends judgment but you can rest assured, if you do not take His mercy, you will get His judgment. The Judgment of God is a last ditch effort to extend grace! [Matthew 5:27-30](#)

(KJV) “*Ye have heard that it was said by them of old time, Thou shalt not commit adultery: ²⁸But I say*

unto you, That whosoever looketh on a woman to lust after her hath committed adultery with her already in his heart. ²⁹And if thy right eye offend thee, pluck it out, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell. ³⁰And if thy right hand offend thee, cut it off, and cast it from thee: for it is profitable for thee that one of thy members should perish, and not that thy whole body should be cast into hell.”

The good news for the sinner is that where sin abounds, grace is more prevalent. Show me a place where sin abounds and I will show you a place where grace is capable of making a major difference.

Romans 5:20 (NKJV) “... *But where sin abounded, grace abounded much more,*” Look at the word abounds in Scripture. There are two Greek words for this one English word.:

- Sin abounded - pleonazo (pleh-on-ad'-zo – flay-on-odd-zo) To exist in abundance. To increase.
- Grace abounded - hyperperisseuo (hoop-er-per-is-syoo'-o – hooper-per-is-o) To abound beyond measure. To abound exceedingly. To overflow.

In other words, where sin abounds it is restricted by certain limits. Where Grace abounds there is absolutely no limitations.

The woman in our story had committed an infraction which should have cost her life! She was a dead woman walking but Jesus showed up and listen to

what He said, John 8:6-11 (CEV) “... *Jesus simply bent over and started writing on the ground with his finger.* ⁷ *They kept on asking Jesus about the woman. Finally, he stood up and said, “If any of you have never sinned, then go ahead and throw the first stone at her!”* ⁸ *Once again he bent over and began writing on the ground.* ⁹ *The people left one by one, beginning with the oldest. Finally, Jesus and the woman were there alone.* ¹⁰ *Jesus stood up and asked her, “Where is everyone? Isn’t there anyone left to accuse you?”* ¹¹ *“No sir,” the woman answered. Then Jesus told her, “I am not going to accuse you either. You may go now, but don’t sin anymore.”*”

The good news is that when the sinner meets grace the debt is paid in full!

I follow Him because:

- He is the wisdom of the wise
- He is the power of the powerful
- He is the ancient of days
- He is the ruler of rulers
- He is the leader of leaders
- He is the overseer of the over-comers

He is:

- My guide
- Holy
- The source of my joy
- The Lord of my life
- The light of my salvation
- The love of my life

- The peace which passes all understanding
- Powerful in all of His ways
- My purity
- Righteousness to my soul
- The ruler of the universe
- The Savior of my soul

His:

- Goodness is to all generations
- Kindness greater than what is deserved
- Gentleness is beyond imagination
- Ways are right
- Word is eternal
- Will is unchanging
- Mind is on me

I serve Him because:

- His bond is love
- His burden is light
- His goal for me is abundant life

His goal is a relationship with me! He will never:

- Leave me
- Forsake me
- Forget me
- Mislead me
- Overlook me
- Cancel my appointment in His appointment book

When the sinner meets grace nothing will ever be the same!

III. THE BELIEVER, SIN AND GRACE

1 John 1:9 (AV) ***"If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins, and to cleanse us from all unrighteousness."*** We have talked about the sinner and law, the sinner and grace, now I want us to focus on what happens when a saint sins! What? Can there be such a thing as a sinning saint?

I want to ask a question *"Is there anyone present who has not committed a sin since you were converted?"* I rest my case, the fact is, all of us have sinned, both before and after conversion. So what can be done when a believer sins? 1 John 2:1-2 (CEV) ***"My children, I am writing this so that you won't sin. But if you do sin, Jesus Christ always does the right thing, and he will speak to the Father for us. ² Christ is the sacrifice that takes away our sins and the sins of all the world's people."*** There are five things in this Scripture worth paying attention to:

- We are instructed not to sin – The Christian should be attempting to defeat sin at all times. (There are more ways to live above sin than to rent a room above a bar!)
- If we sin a path to purity has been provided – There is forgiveness for the believer who finds his/her self having failed.
- Jesus pleads our case before the Father – He is our attorney! ***"He ever lives to make intercession for us."***

- The sacrifice of Jesus is for the believer – John is writing to believers when He says “***Christ is the sacrifice that takes away our sins.***” Here he states that forgiveness is for every believer and even includes himself in the equation.
- The sacrifice of Jesus is for the lost - “***...and the sins of all the world’s people.***”

The forgiveness which Christ provides is not just a matter of expunging the record of our offences but actually “***...cleanses us from all unrighteousness.***”

Other instructions are given for what should happen when a saint sins. Galatians 6:1 (CEV) “***Brethren, if a man is overtaken in any trespass, you who are spiritual restore such a one in a spirit of gentleness, considering yourself lest you also be tempted.***” The writer of Galatians gives us a five point outline for dealing with the sins of the saints:

- The sinning saint must be confronted – Allowing people to continue in sin is neither profitable to them nor the Kingdom of God.
- Restoration is the order of the day – When a saint sins restoration and redemption should be the intention of the body of Christ.
- Spiritual people should provide a path to restoration – Usually this should be church leaders or their designees. The people who know about the failure should be kept to a minimum. This was not the case in the woman caught in the act of adultery. Mercy demands confidentiality; religion demands public humiliation!

- Restoration should be accomplished through gentleness – Nothing is to be gained with harshness. A sinning saint is already dealing with enough condemnation, the last thing they need is blame being assigned by fellow believers.
- Exercise caution – Great caution should be exercised when the restoration process is in operation. Compromise is not what is needed; bringing justice and mercy together is what is desired. The tendency is to spin the failure so that it does not appear to be so bad; the danger is that even spiritual people can fall into the same trap as the sinning saint has fallen into.

The sacrifice of Jesus does not just provide forgiveness; it provides complete pardon from sins activities! The woman caught in the act of adultery in John eight experienced this very thing. *John 8:9-10 (CEV) “Finally, Jesus and the woman were there alone. ¹⁰ Jesus stood up and asked her, “Where is everyone? Isn’t there anyone left to accuse you?” ¹¹ “No sir,” the woman answered. Then Jesus told her, “I am not going to accuse you either. You may go now, but don’t sin anymore.”*

CONCLUSION:

Isaiah 53:5 (AV) *“But he was wounded for our transgressions, he was bruised for our iniquities: the chastisement of our peace was upon him; and with his stripes we are healed.”* **(LEAVE ON SCREEN UNTIL END OF SERVICE)**

ILLUSTRATION: (Eating a meal in a restaurant then finding out someone paid your bill.)

Whether it is the sinner being confronted by the law; the sinner meeting grace; or the saint who has sinned; when Jesus enters the picture everything changes!

- When we fall, He lifts us up
- When we fail, He forgives
- When we are weak, He is strong
- When we are lost, He is the way
- When we are afraid, He is our courage
- When we stumble, He steadies us
- When we are hurt, He heals us
- When we are broken, He mends us
- When we are blind, He leads us along
- When we are hungry, He gives us food to eat
- When we face trials, He is with us
- When we are persecuted, He shields us
- When we face problems, He empowers us
- When we face loss, He provides comfort for us
- When we face death, He carries us home

He is everything for everybody everywhere, every time, and in every way. He is God, He is faithful. I am His, and He is mine! He paid my debt in full and now I belong to Him!